

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	PORTABLE CIRCULAR SAW - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Operations Manager - Paneltec Pty Ltd and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Check equipment	Electrocutions, cuts & other injuries from the saw	1	1. All electric leads should be intact with no damage to insulation. 2. Leads should have been checked and display a checked tag within last 3 months. 3. All outside sheathing properly secured by retaining rings on plugs, no internal wires showing. 4. Adjust saw for depth of cut & angle. 5. All adjusting screws should be tight.	Supervisor Operator	2
Prepare the work	Slips, trips, sprains & strains	2	1. Check work is properly supported and won't slide, topple or tilt. 2. Check cut will be clear of supports. 3. Check off-cut will fall safely or will be supported. Check electric cord will reach along the cut. 4. Check floor is clear of obstructions & debris. 5. Operator position must be comfortable, no reaching or off balance. 6. Get assistance to hold work if necessary. 7. Check saw dust will not go where it is not wanted. Mark guideline or damp guide or set fence. Prepare a spot to put the saw after each cut – two blocks, blade goes between & guard is off floor.	Operator	3
Prepare yourself	Noise, dust (Eyes, inhaling), falling off-cuts	2	1. Use P.P.E including eye, hearing protection & safety footwear.	Operator	3
Pick up saw	Electrocutions, cuts & other injuries from the saw	1	1. At this stage all leads should be plugged in, power turned on and P.P.E adjusted ready to proceed. Use main handle with right hand & trigger finger purposely, held away from trigger. 2. Develop habit of keeping finger off the trigger when not cutting. Left-handers should develop this method as the tool is designed to be operated on the right-hand side of the body.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			- Left hand on front knob takes weight to hold saw level, weight should be distributed evenly over both hands, otherwise right wrist suffers. - Locate electric cord away from work, over right shoulder & down back to surplus cord on floor, to be left and slightly behind operator - Alternate – over right shoulder, around back of neck & under left arm to surplus in same position. Check natural limits of movement to make sure cord is free to move & doesn't drag on neck of shoulder.		
Position the saw	Slips, trips, sprains & strains	1	- Place front of saw loose on work. - Check your position so that cut can be completed without unnecessary repositioning of feet & without overreaching. - If guard requires holding back at start, use left thumb on guard lever & grip front knob with remainder of hand.	Operator	2
Make the cut	Slips, trips, sprains, strains & cuts	2	- Press trigger – operator should be braced to counter any kick. - Line up guard on saw with guide. - Lean on work or side of base against clamped guide or fence. - Check the right forearm is in line with line of cut and elbow is low enough to direct pushing force directly through the wrist to the saw. - Left hand on front knob steadies saw & helps control location with steady pressure against fence or clamped guide. - Right arm & shoulder provide the pushing power, right hand keeps saw on cutting line. - At the beginning of the cut, keep watching the tip of the blade as it cuts the work at the line and at the same time, adjust the position of the guide mark on the saw base. You need to get used to the accuracy of this mark.	Operator	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			8. Note – eye protection should be in place. 9. The lining up of the guide mark & blade in 2 above, sets the line of the saw provided your right arm is in the correct position (as above) and the saw blade is in good condition, you will be able to make a clean cut, straight & safely. 10. During the cut, guide mark on saw base. should be kept following the line or firm pressure should be maintained to hold saw against a clamped guide or fence. 11. Concentration should be on keeping the saw on line and maintaining proper balance. Be ready at the end of the cut to take weight of saw as it comes off the work. 12. Speed of cut should be fast enough to keep the blade cutting but not fast enough to put a heavy load on the motor and cause the motor to slow down.		
At end of cut	Slips, trips, sprains, strains, cuts & other injuries from the saw	2	1. Take finger off trigger as soon as saw is no longer cutting. 2. Let the saw rest on the work while you reposition yourself to pick it up without undue strain. 3. When it is picked up, check that the guard has returned over the blade. 4. Wait for the blade to stop turning. 5. Do not put the saw on the floor without having a block under it. 6. The weight of the saw should be on the base and not on the guard.	Operator	3
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	4. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 5. Emergency numbers available on site. 6. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training	
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018		
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019		
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018		
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		Safe Design of Structures - 2018		
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING**Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS**

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.